



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Chesterton Academy of St. Joseph
School Website: <https://www.chestertonacademyofstjoseph.org/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Chesterton Academy of St. Joseph (Fairborn, OH, 45324) presents a robust, publicly visible model of classical education rooted in Catholic faith and the liberal arts. Public materials repeatedly describe the school as a “joyfully Catholic, classical high school,” foregrounding the integration of faith, great books, and classical pedagogy. Evidence across the site highlights a Catholic identity, the study of great thinkers, the Socratic method, a canonical humanities-based curriculum, the Seven Liberal Arts influence, a house system designed to cultivate virtue, and a strong emphasis on character formation and community life, including partnerships with families via parent liaisons and other structures. Taken together, these signals align strongly with the six elements of classical education, indicating a CLASSICAL overall classification for Chesterton Academy of St. Joseph.

Across the six categories, Chesterton Academy of St. Joseph demonstrates substantial alignment with classical criteria:

- Religious and Metaphysical Foundations: explicit Catholic identity, theology integration, and liturgical/communal rhythm are evident (highly Classical).
- School Purpose and Goal: formation, virtue, and the aim of a substantive liberal-arts education are clearly stated (Classical).
- Curriculum: explicit Great Books/Great Conversation orientations through mentions of great thinkers and a braided, integrated humanities approach; math/science tied to philosophy/theology also signals a holistic liberal-arts framework (Classical).
- Pedagogy: Socratic/dialogical pedagogy in upper levels, with recognition of memorization/reverence in lower levels (Scholé-like elements) and a rhythm that includes spoken rhetoric and memory-based pedagogy (Classical).
- Faculty: public-facing bios and descriptions frame faculty as masterful, virtuous mentors and the living curriculum; there is emphasis on character and scholarly excellence among teachers (Classical).
- Parents & Community: explicit partnership with families (parent liaisons in the house system) and community engagement; openness to parent involvement is evident (Classical).

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL
- Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL
- Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL
- Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL
- Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL
- Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

ABSTRACT

conclusions: Chesterton Academy of St. Joseph demonstrates a comprehensive CLASSICAL orientation across all six categories, with explicit Catholic identity, Great Books-oriented curriculum, Socratic pedagogy, and active family partnerships. The public materials align closely with the Six Essential Elements of a Classical School (1) rubric, including the emphasis on formation, truth/goodness/beauty, the liberal arts, wonder, Socratic culture, and open-family engagement.

What would move the needle

- No needle-moving changes are required to reach CLASSICAL across all six categories given the current public materials. If a school were to move further toward the idealized canonical classical model, it could explicitly document:
- A formal Great Conversation/Great Books initiative with required Great Books readings and explicit references to canonical authors across grade bands.
- Greater emphasis on the Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and Quadrivium (arithmetic, geometry, music, astronomy) in the published curriculum map, with clear alignment to assessment.
- Additional liturgical/communal life documentation (e.g., explicit weekly liturgical practices or chapel calendar) to strengthen the Liturgical and Communal Practices signal.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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